

Marigold 08 2023

Originator: Spandana Sphoorty Financial Limited

October 27, 2023

Instrument [#]	Amount (₹ crore)	Rating ¹	Rating Action
Series A1 PTCs	100.00	CARE AA- (SO)	Final rating assigned

[#]The pass-through certificates (PTCs) are rated based on the timely payment of interest and the payment of principal by the final legal maturity. Details of instruments/facilities in Annexure-1.

Rationale and key rating drivers

CARE Ratings Limited (CARE Ratings) had assigned the rating of 'Provisional CARE AA- (SO)' (pronounced as 'Double A Minus [Structured Obligation]') to the Series A1 PTCs issued by Marigold 08 2023, backed by a pool of microfinance loan receivables originated by Spandana Sphoorty Financial Limited (SFPL).

The rating is now confirmed and 'CARE AA- (SO)' (pronounced as 'Double A Minus [Structured Obligation]') has been assigned to Series A1 PTCs.

Furthermore, the above rating was final based on the below-mentioned documents submitted to the satisfaction of CARE Ratings:

- Account Agreement
- Assignment Agreement
- Servicing Agreement
- Trust Deed
- Power of Attorney
- Information Memorandum
- Legal opinion from an independent legal counsel
- KYC Audit Report.

Rating sensitivities: Factors likely to lead to rating actions

Positive factors – Factors that could, individually or collectively, lead to positive rating action/upgrade:

- Delinquencies (90+ DPD) of <2% coupled with a sustained high collection efficiency (cumulative collection efficiency of >98%).
- Build-up of cash collateral (CC) of more than 2x the initial proposed (as a percentage of the balance principal outstanding [POS]).

Negative factors – Factors that could, individually or collectively, lead to negative rating action/downgrade:

- Delinquencies (90+ DPD) of >5% coupled with a sustained lower collection efficiency (cumulative collection efficiency of <90%).
- Sharp deterioration in the credit profile of the originator.
- Non-adherence to key transaction terms envisaged at the time of the rating.

Analytical approach

[CARE Ratings' methodology for asset/mortgage-backed securitisation](#)

Detailed description of the key rating drivers

The rating assigned is finalised based on the structure provided to CARE Ratings by SFPL, the originator. The rating has been confirmed after copies of the legal documents executed in accordance with the structure, a due-diligence audit report by an external auditor, and an independent legal opinion was furnished by the originator (SFPL), to the satisfaction of CARE Ratings.

Key strengths:

- Robustness of the transaction structure and a well-defined payment mechanism.
- Credit enhancement (CE) comprising CC, subordinated over collateral (OC), and excess interest spread (EIS).
- No overdue contracts as on the pool cut-off date, ever current pool since origination.

¹Complete definition of the ratings assigned are available at www.careedge.in and other CARE Ratings Ltd.'s publications

- Underwriting policies and the collection capabilities of SSFL.
- High weighted average seasoning (based on EMIs paid) of around 6.6 months with amortisation of around 22.5%.

Key weakness:

- Weak borrower profile, as this segment is susceptible to socio-political interference and other external shocks.

Liquidity: Strong

The inherent liquidity in the structure is strong. The interest payouts for Series A1 PTCs are promised on a monthly basis, while the principal of Series A1 PTCs is promised to be paid by final legal maturity. In case of any delinquency, the payouts are expected to be supported by CE consisting of CC, principal subordination in the form of OC, and EIS.

Key rating assumptions

CARE Ratings has analysed the transaction to assess whether the CE is sufficient to cover the shortfalls. Since the transaction is sensitive to the credit quality of the underlying pool, CARE Ratings has analysed the performance of static pools provided by the originator and the overall portfolio performance of the originator. Considering the borrower profile, nature of the loan, pool characteristics, and portfolio performance, CARE Ratings has taken the average shortfall at 10.50-12.50% of the POS. The base case shortfalls were stressed along with other key factors, such as the timing of shortfalls, the recovery assumptions, and the time to recovery. The pool cash flow has been further adjusted for prepayments of underlying loans assuming monthly prepayments in the range of 0.5-1.0%.

Applicable criteria

[Policy on Default Recognition](#)

[CARE Ratings' methodology for asset/mortgage-backed securitisation](#)

About the company and industry
Industry classification

Macro-economic Indicator	Sector	Industry	Basic Industry
Financial services	Financial services	Finance	Securitisation

SSFL is primarily engaged in extending microfinance loans through the joint liability group (JLG) model, primarily to borrowers belonging to low-income households. In 2003, the company was registered with the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) as a non-deposit taking non-banking finance company (NBFC-ND) and is currently registered under the new category of NBFC-microfinance institution (MFI). The company went into corporate debt restructuring (CDR) post the Andhra Pradesh crisis in 2010 and exited the CDR in April 2017.

As of September 2023, Padmaja Reddy, holds around 15% stake in the company and is a member of the board but does not hold significant control. Other major stakeholders are Kedaara Capital and Affiliates (holding 48.27%), JM Financial Products Limited (holding 2.27%), and Valiant Mauritius Partners FDI Limited (holding 3.15%). The new CEO, Shalabh Saxena, and CFO, Ashish Damani, have come from Bharat Financial Inclusion Limited. The positions of CTO, CBO, and CXO were also filled thereafter by Kedaara Capital.

Key financial indicators – SSFL

Particulars	FY21 (A)	FY22 (A)	FY23 (A)	Q1FY24 (UA)
Total income (₹ crore)	1,465	1,392	1,394	502
PAT (₹ crore)	1026	862	12	111
Interest coverage (times)	1.42	1.18	1.13	1.78
Total assets (₹ crore)	8,241	6,676	9,185	9,589
Net NPA (%)	3.27%	6.78%	0.58%	0.45%
ROTA (%)	1.55%	0.68%	0.16%	1.18%

A: Audited; UA: Unaudited. Note: The above results are the latest financial results available.

Status of non-cooperation with the previous CRA: Not applicable

Any other information: Nil

Rating history for the last three years: Please refer Annexure-2

Covenants of the rated instruments/facilities: Detailed explanation of the covenants of the rated instruments/facilities is given in Annexure-3

Complexity level of the various instruments: Annexure-4

Lender details: Annexure-5

Annexure-1: Details of instruments/facilities

Name of the Instrument	ISIN	Date of Issuance (DD-MM-YYYY)	Coupon Rate	Maturity Date (DD-MM-YYYY)	Size of the Issue (₹ crore)	Rating Assigned along with Rating Outlook
Pass through certificates	-	01-08-2023	10.00%	15-03-2025	100.00	CARE AA- (SO)

Annexure-2: Rating history for the last three years

Sr. No.	Name of the Instrument/Bank Facilities	Current Ratings			Rating History			
		Type	Amount Outstanding (₹ crore)	Rating	Date(s) and Rating(s) assigned in 2023-2024	Date(s) and Rating(s) assigned in 2022-2023	Date(s) and Rating(s) assigned in 2021-2022	Date(s) and Rating(s) assigned in 2020-2021
1	Pass through certificates	LT	100.00	CARE AA- (SO)	1)Provisional CARE AA- (SO) (03-Aug-23)	-	-	-

LT*: Long term.

Annexure-3: Detailed explanation of the covenants of the rated instruments/facilities

Not applicable

Annexure-4: Complexity level of the various instruments rated

Sr. No.	Name of Instrument	Complexity Level
1.	Pass-through certificates	Highly complex

Annexure-5: Lender details

Not applicable

Note on the complexity levels of the rated instruments: CARE Ratings has classified instruments rated by it on the basis of complexity. Investors/market intermediaries/regulators or others are welcome to write to care@careedge.in for any clarifications.

Contact us

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About us:

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